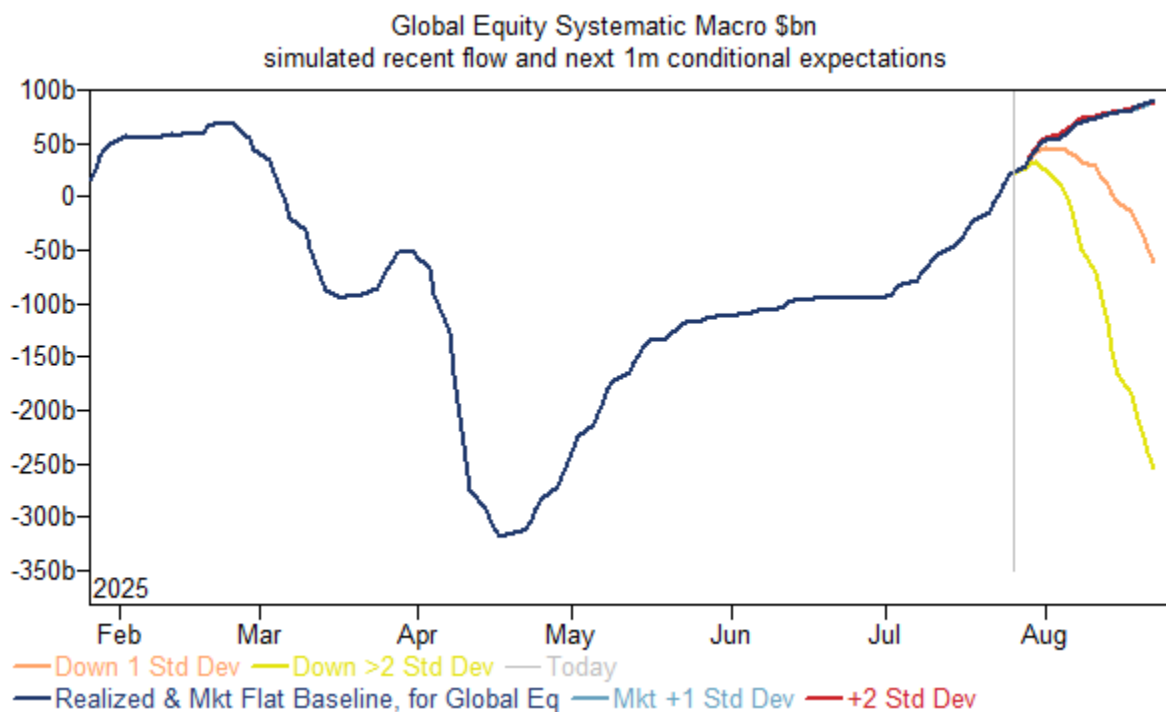

GOLDMAN SACHS FICC AND EQUITIES

FUTURES SALES STRATS

Systematic & Futures Update: Continuation, growing length and some performance improvement

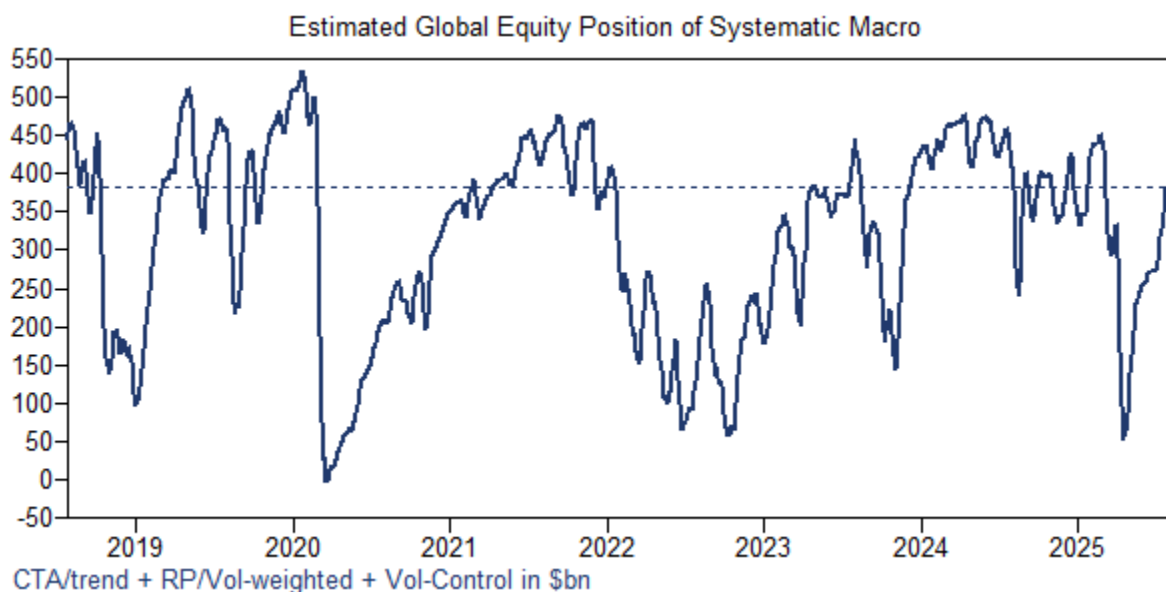
1. CTA/trend followers have been **continued equity buyers as expected, adding to their long length**, which has been overall right-way with price action that hit new ATHs this week in SPX. The vol-based systematic investors – risk parity style and VA vol-control – have been adding in secondary size also, and collectively, the total estimated **global equity length currently stands at nearly a 7 out of 10 and is expected to climb to above an 8 after the next one month's baseline flow**. The monthly figure is \$80bn, of which \$35bn or 44% is expected to be in US markets. The slope or pace of the buying will naturally start to flatten after the next week but remains upward sloping currently (Chart 1 below). This positioning has **helped CTA performance claw back a subset of its YTD losses**, where NEIXCTAT is still down a meaningful 8% on the year vs. more than 12% at the lows in May. We estimate that this positive recent performance has been led by the equities bucket, while other asset classes have generally been more mixed or challenged. Separately **liquidity remains at its cyclically improved levels given the lower volatility** notwithstanding lower summer volumes, and SPX **gamma hedging flows remain overall pro-cyclical and risk-positive** with buy estimates considerably bigger on equivalent up/down spot moves currently.

2. In the **industry data overall**, institutional and total non-dealer **US equity length** remained at or below its 1-yr average but a higher 71-76% historical rank on a min-max scale. Institutional **UST length** has come a little off its record highs in recent weeks, including \$25mm/bp or 1.7x std deviation of sales this week but remains at historically high levels, and with “non-commercials” or specs meaningfully net short. Overall non-dealer **dollar flows remained modest-sized in FX** – the last time we saw a >1x std deviation week was back in April – and **length at 1-yr lows but not a historical max short** (24% current historical rank). And in commodities, energies were small-moderately net sold by money managers while **gold saw a sizable near \$10bn of buying, 2x std deviation flow and the biggest nominal buy week in more than a year**, to take net contract length to a 42% 1-yr rank and 74% normalized historical rank. We expect the systematic **CTA/trend following buying of gold to continue**, from \$1.7bn in the last one week to \$2.1 in the next week and \$6.7bn in the next one month cumulative in the baseline scenario.



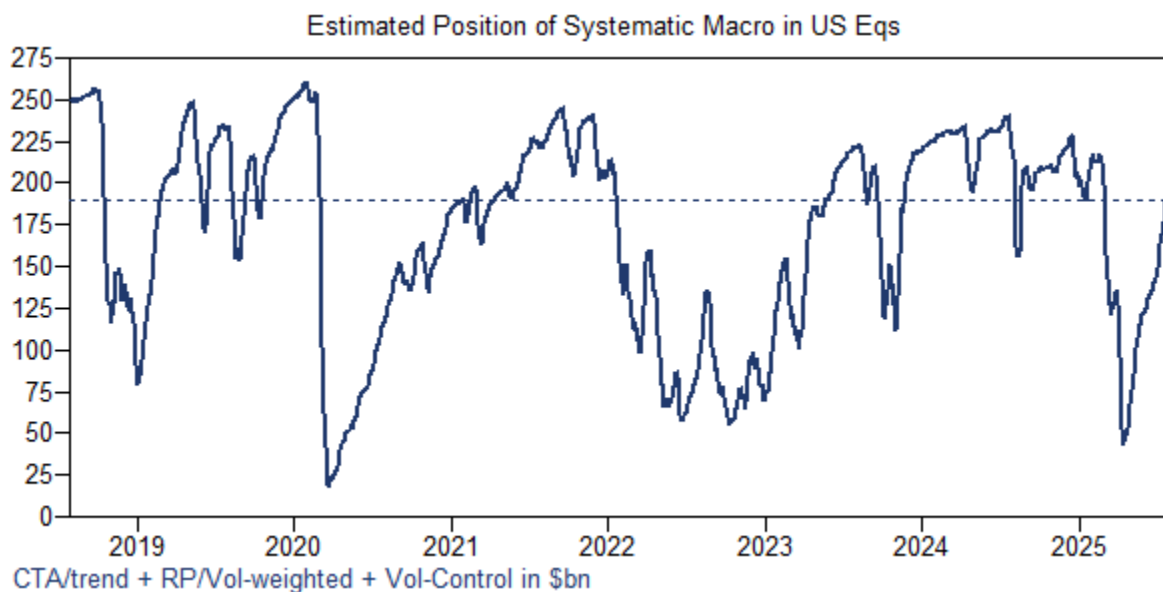
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

Past performance is not indicative of future results



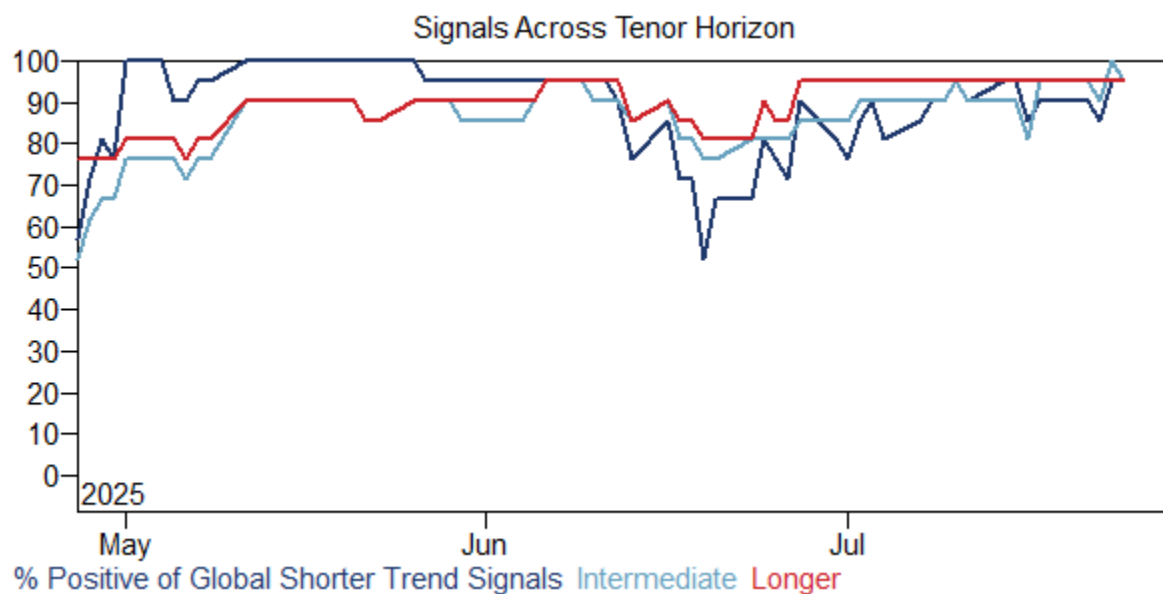
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

Past performance is not indicative of future results



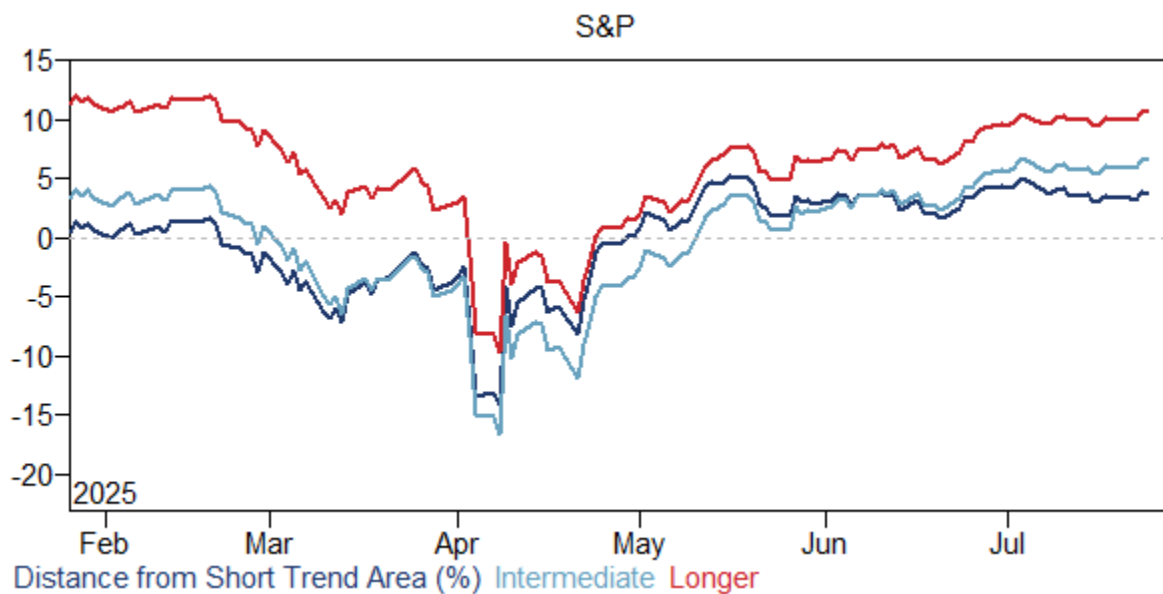
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

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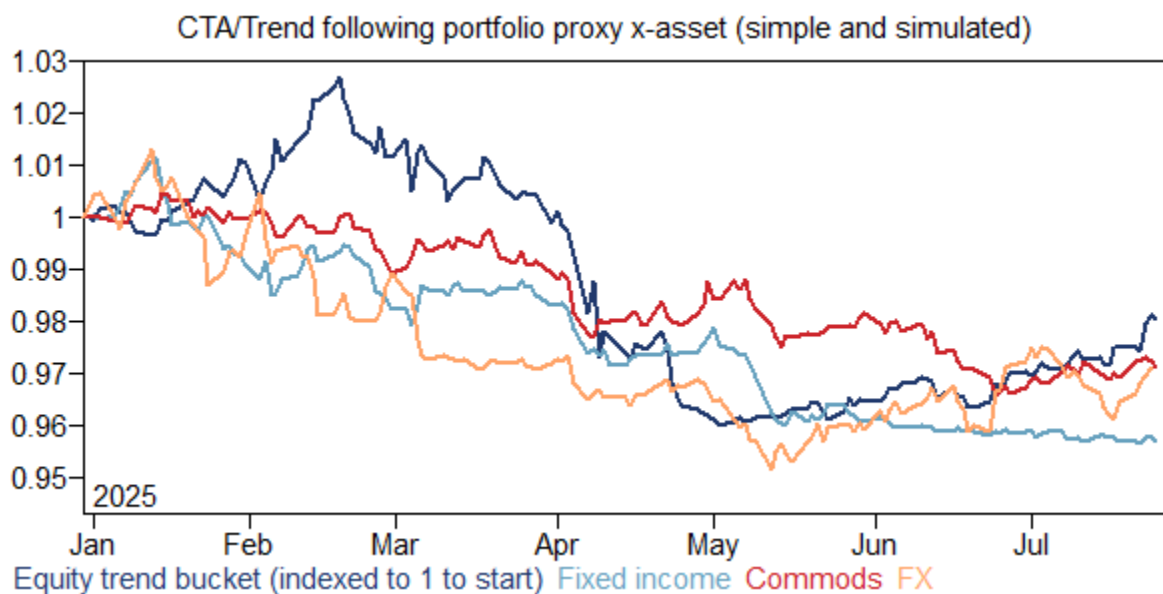
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

Past performance is not indicative of future results



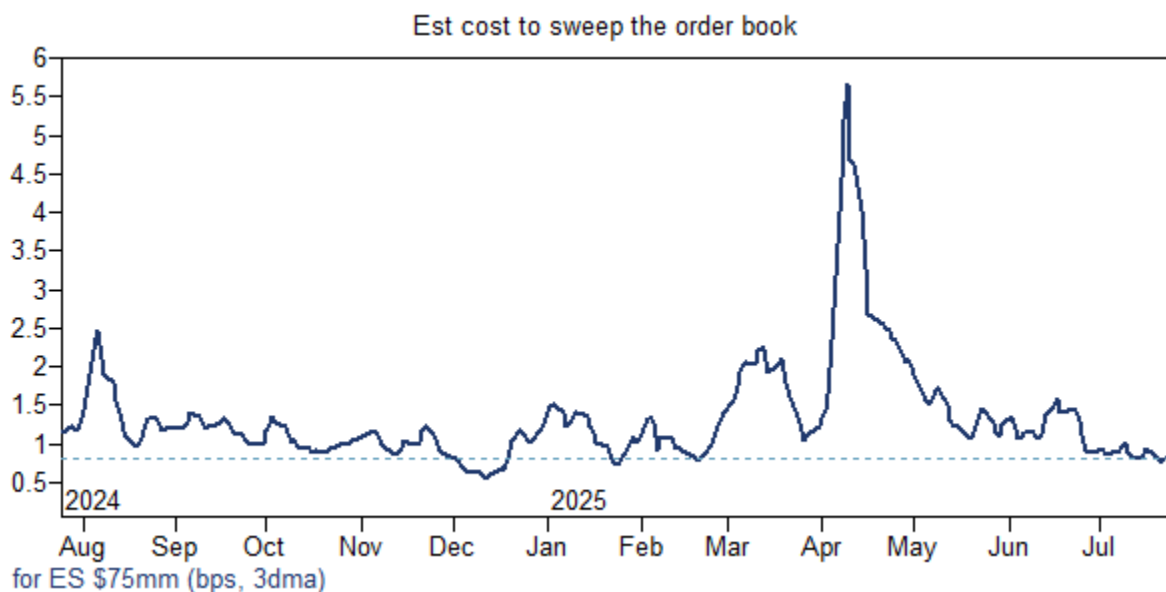
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

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Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

Past performance is not indicative of future results

Spot Level	Total Gamma	Cumulative Delta Flow on Up Market	Cumulative Delta Flow on Down Market
-6%	-2,041		-6,941
-5%	-2,193		-4,748
-4%	-2,018		-2,730
-3%	-395		-2,335
-2%	924		-3,259
-1%	111		-3,369
0%	-3,369		
1%	-4,924	3,369	
2%	-11,999	8,294	
3%	-13,813	20,293	
4%	-7,274	34,106	
5%	-3,667	41,380	
6%	-2,226	45,047	

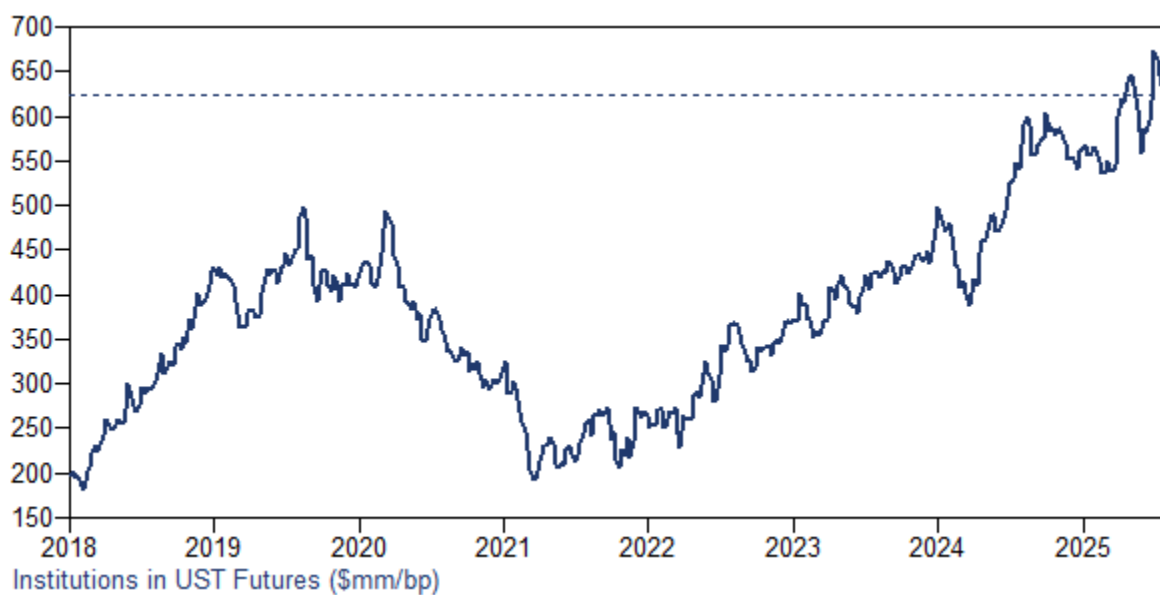
Source: CBOE and Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

Past performance is not indicative of future results



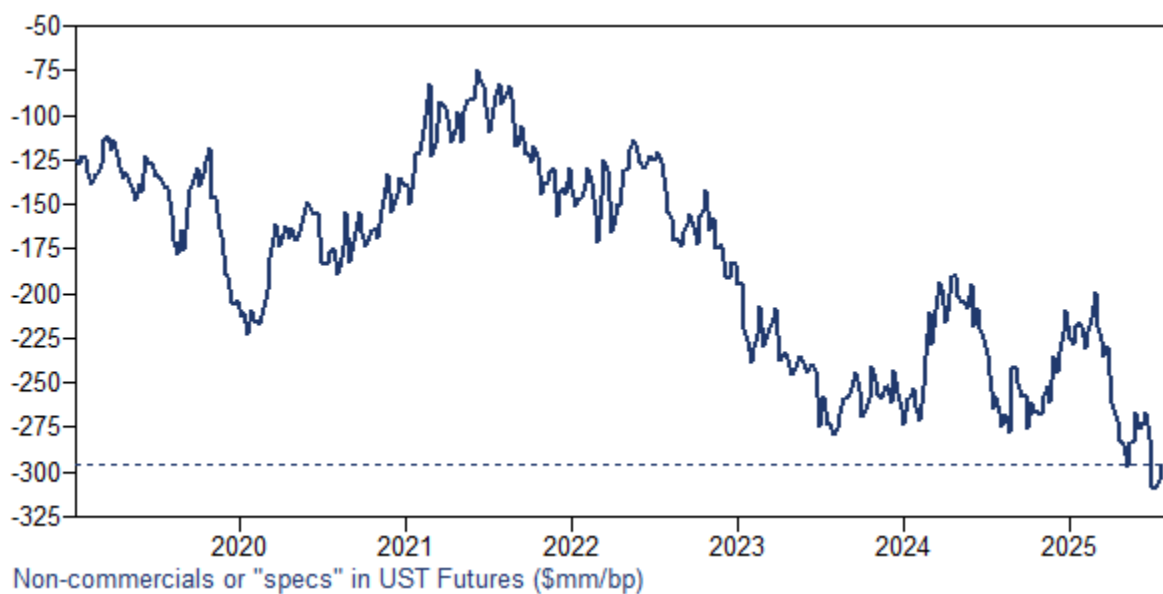
Source: CFTC and Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025

Past performance is not indicative of future results



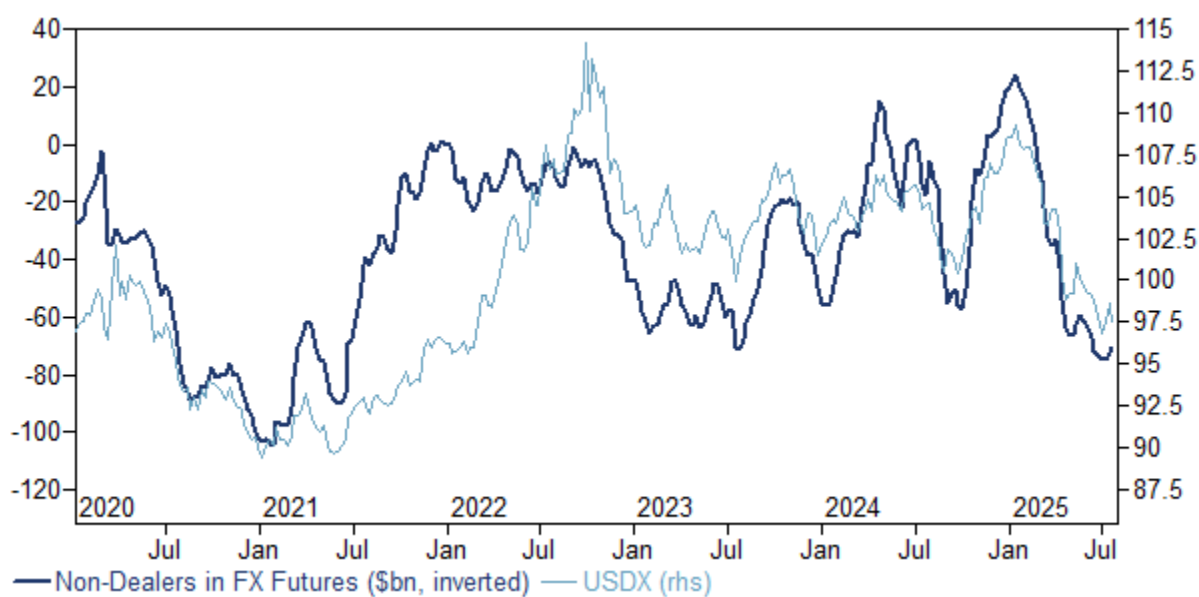
Source: CFTC and Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 22-Jul-2025

Past performance is not indicative of future results



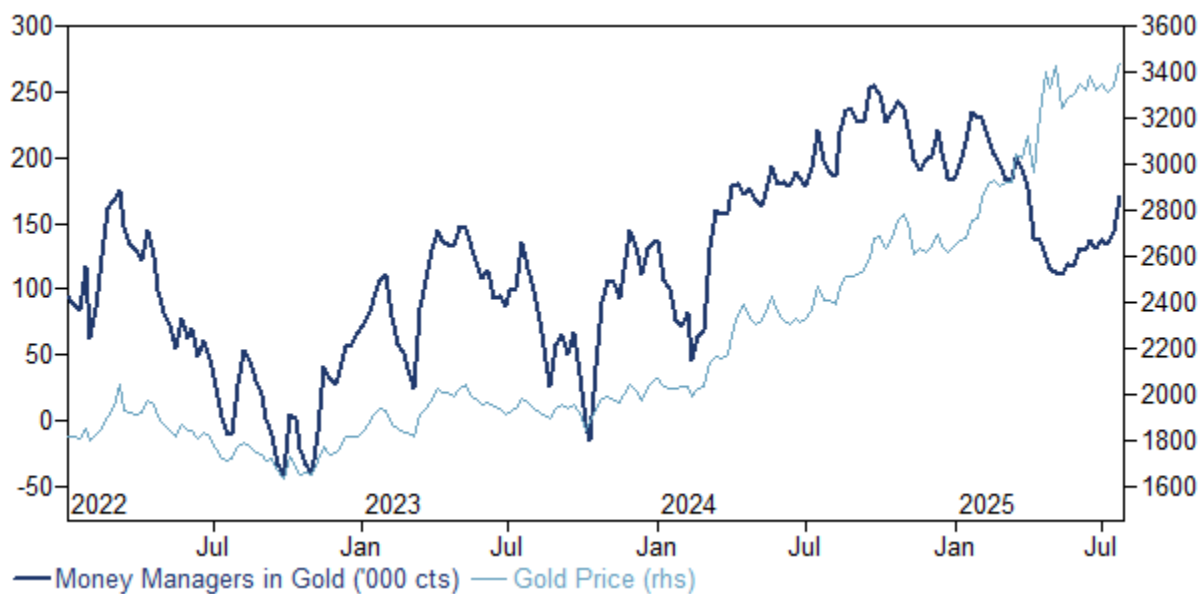
Source: CFTC and Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 22-Jul-2025

Past performance is not indicative of future results



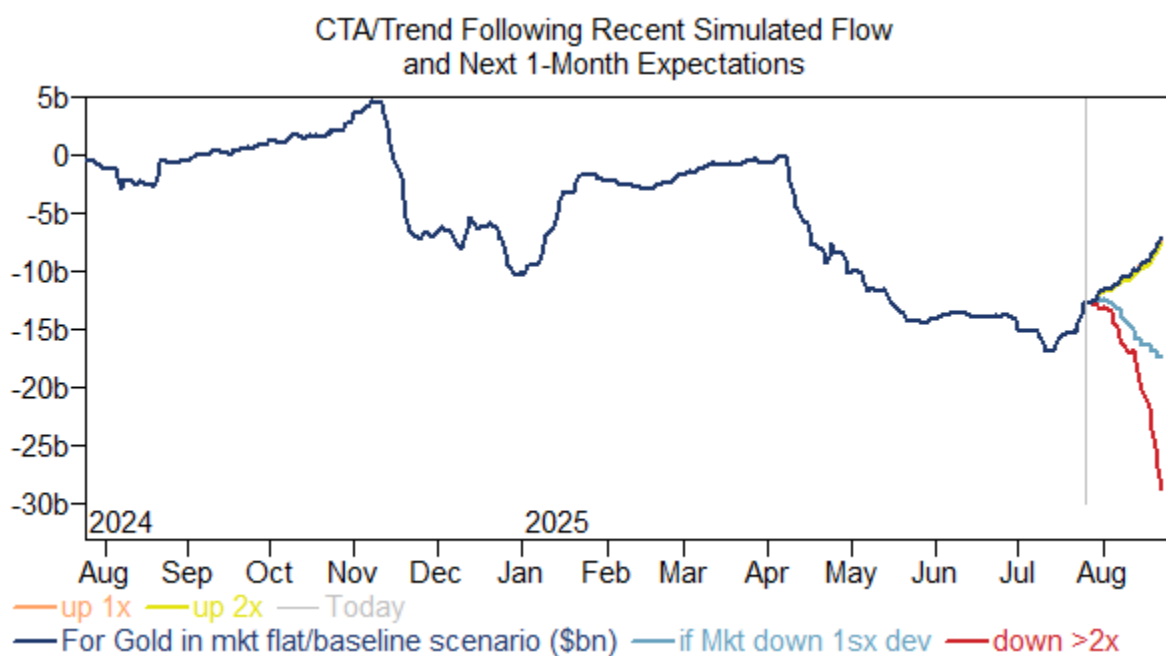
Source: CFTC and Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 22-Jul-2025

Past performance is not indicative of future results



Source: CFTC and Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 22-Jul-2025

Past performance is not indicative of future results



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 24-Jul-2025 markets close

Past performance is not indicative of future results

The systematic or non-CFTC based charts shown are generally all simulated information, and the history shown uses backtesting. The simulated results are for illustrative purposes only. GS provides no assurance or guarantee that the strategy will operate or would have operated in the past in a manner consistent with the above analysis. Past performance figures are not a reliable indicator of future results.

Backtesting analysis is for illustrative purposes only. GS provides no assurance or guarantee that the strategy will operate or would have operated in the past in a manner consistent with the above backtesting analysis. Backtested and/or past performance figures are not a reliable indicator of future results. Backtested data is backtested over the entire range shown.

Note: futures markets are considerably broader than just systematic and systematic investors use more than futures, CFTC categories are clunky, and our referenced systematic estimates are commonly for global markets while CFTC data is for US (futures and/or futures-options) markets only.